THEATRE, PUPPETRY AND PERFORMANCE TRADITIONS

DRAMATIC ROOT SYSTEM → DRAMATIC-MODE FIREWALL → SUTRADHAR ROLE CHAIN → CHARACTER-LANGUAGE MAP → DECLINE AND SURVIVAL → FOLK-THEATRE ARC

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ◇ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 DRAMATIC ROOT SYSTEM

DRAMATIC ROOT SYSTEM · CODIFIED PROGRESSION · NAYAKA, NAYIKA AND VIDUSAKA · AUDIENCE RECEPTION · RITUAL OPENING AND CONVENTION · MUST REMEMBER · PERFORMANCE HISTORY JOINS NATYASHASTRA DRAMATURGY, LOKADHARMI AND NATYADHARMI MODES

PLOT → codified progression → CHARACTER → Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka → RASA → audience reception → STAGE → ritual opening and convention → MUST REMEMBER: Performance history joins Natyashastra dramaturgy, lokadharmi and natyadharmi modes, ten rupakas, Sanskrit

CORE CLAIM
- PLOT → codified progression
- CHARACTER → Nayaka, Nayika and Vidusaka

MECHANISM
- RASA → audience reception
- STAGE → ritual opening and convention

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Performance history joins Natyashastra dramaturgy, lokadharmi and natyadharmi modes, ten rupakas, Sanskrit
- stage roles and registers, regional folk theatre, four puppet media and post-1947 institutions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Performance history joins Natyashastra dramaturgy, lokadharmi and natyadharmi modes, ten rupakas, Sanskrit stage roles and registers, regional folk theatre, four puppet media and post-1947 institutions.

01

STAGE 01 DRAMATIC-MODE FIREWALL

DRAMATIC-MODE FIREWALL · REALISTIC DAILY-LIFE REPRESENTATION · STYLISED SYMBOLIC NARRATION · MAY COMBINE BOTH · DO NOT REVERSE THE PAIR

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
LOKADHARMI → realistic daily-life representation	PERFORMANCE → may combine both	LOKADHARMI → realistic daily-life representation
NATYADHARMI → stylised symbolic narration	TRAP → do not reverse the pair	NATYADHARMI → stylised symbolic narration

CORE CLAIM
- LOKADHARMI → realistic daily-life representation
- NATYADHARMI → stylised symbolic narration

MECHANISM
- PERFORMANCE → may combine both
- TRAP → do not reverse the pair

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- LOKADHARMI → realistic daily-life representation
- NATYADHARMI → stylised symbolic narration

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PERFORMANCE → may combine both; TRAP → do not reverse the pair.

02

STAGE 02 SUTRADHAR ROLE CHAIN

SUTRADHAR ROLE CHAIN · RITUAL PREPARATION · TIME, PLACE AND PLAY · STAGE MANAGEMENT · PERFORMANCE ORDER · NARRATOR AND HOLDER-OF-STRINGS SENSE

PRELIMINARIES → ritual preparation → INTRODUCTION → time, place and play → STAGE MANAGEMENT → performance order → PUPPETRY → narrator and holder-of-strings sense

CORE CLAIM
- PRELIMINARIES → ritual preparation
- INTRODUCTION → time, place and play

MECHANISM
- STAGE MANAGEMENT → performance order
- PUPPETRY → narrator and holder-of-strings sense

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PRELIMINARIES → ritual preparation
- INTRODUCTION → time, place and play

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STAGE MANAGEMENT → performance order; PUPPETRY → narrator and holder-of-strings sense.

03

STAGE 03 CHARACTER-LANGUAGE MAP

CHARACTER-LANGUAGE MAP · HERO TYPE · HEROINE TYPE · COMIC AND SATIRICAL FRIEND · MARKED SPEECH REGISTER

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NAYAKA → hero type	VIDUSAKA → comic and satirical friend	NAYAKA → hero type
NAYIKA → heroine type	PRAKRIT → marked speech register	NAYIKA → heroine type

CORE CLAIM
- NAYAKA → hero type
- NAYIKA → heroine type

MECHANISM
- VIDUSAKA → comic and satirical friend
- PRAKRIT → marked speech register

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NAYAKA → hero type
- NAYIKA → heroine type

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VIDUSAKA → comic and satirical friend; PRAKRIT → marked speech register.

04

STAGE 04 DECLINE AND SURVIVAL

DECLINE AND SURVIVAL · WRITERS SHIFT · POETRY AND SONG · LANGUAGE BARRIER · SANSKRIT LOSES REACH · PATRONAGE SHIFT · COURT ECOLOGY CHANGES · REGIONAL LIVING CONTINUITY

WRITERS SHIFT → poetry and song → LANGUAGE BARRIER → Sanskrit loses reach → PATRONAGE SHIFT → court ecology changes → KUTIYATTAM → regional living continuity

CORE CLAIM
- WRITERS SHIFT → poetry and song
- LANGUAGE BARRIER → Sanskrit loses reach

MECHANISM
- PATRONAGE SHIFT → court ecology changes
- KUTIYATTAM → regional living continuity

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- WRITERS SHIFT → poetry and song
- LANGUAGE BARRIER → Sanskrit loses reach

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PATRONAGE SHIFT → court ecology changes; KUTIYATTAM → regional living continuity.

05

STAGE 05 FOLK-THEATRE ARC

FOLK-THEATRE ARC · EARLY REGIONAL THEMES · LOCAL NARRATIVE EXPANSION · SOCIAL MESSAGE · POST-INDEPENDENCE USE · STAGES OVERLAP BY REGION

DEVOTIONAL → early regional themes → ROMANCE / HERO → local narrative expansion → SOCIAL MESSAGE → post-Independence use → RULE → stages overlap by region

CORE CLAIM
- DEVOTIONAL → early regional themes
- ROMANCE / HERO → local narrative expansion

MECHANISM
- SOCIAL MESSAGE → post-Independence use
- RULE → stages overlap by region

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DEVOTIONAL → early regional themes
- ROMANCE / HERO → local narrative expansion

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOCIAL MESSAGE → post-Independence use; RULE → stages overlap by region.

06

STAGE 06 MODERN THEATRE SEQUENCE

MODERN THEATRE SEQUENCE · COLONIAL CITY AND COMMERCE · 1876 ACT · POLITICAL CONTROL · CIRCULATION AND MOBILISATION · INSTITUTIONAL TRAINING

PROSCENIUM → colonial city and commerce → 1876 ACT → political control → PARSI / IPTA → circulation and mobilisation → SNA / NSD → institutional training

CORE CLAIM
- PROSCENIUM → colonial city and commerce
- 1876 ACT → political control

MECHANISM
- PARSI / IPTA → circulation and mobilisation
- SNA / NSD → institutional training

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PROSCENIUM → colonial city and commerce
- 1876 ACT → political control

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PARSI / IPTA → circulation and mobilisation; SNA / NSD → institutional training.

07

STAGE 07 PUPPETRY MECHANISM MATRIX

PUPPETRY MECHANISM MATRIX · SUSPENDED MARIONETTE · CUT-OUT BEFORE A LIT SCREEN · FIGURE MOVED FROM BELOW OR BEHIND · FINGERS INSIDE A SLEEVE BODY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
STRING → suspended marionette	ROD → figure moved from below or behind	STRING → suspended marionette
SHADOW → cut-out before a lit screen	GLOVE → fingers inside a sleeve body	SHADOW → cut-out before a lit screen

CORE CLAIM
- STRING → suspended marionette
- SHADOW → cut-out before a lit screen

MECHANISM
- ROD → figure moved from below or behind
- GLOVE → fingers inside a sleeve body

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- STRING → suspended marionette
- SHADOW → cut-out before a lit screen

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ROD → figure moved from below or behind.

08

STAGE 08 STRING-PUPPET DISTINCTIONS

STRING-PUPPET DISTINCTIONS · LEGLESS RAJASTHAN DOLL · JOINTED ODISHA FIGURE · YAKSHAGANA-STYLED KARNATAKA FIGURE · STRINGS, BUT DIFFERENT BODIES

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
KATHPUTLI → legless Rajasthan doll	GOMBEYATTA → Yakshagana-styled Karnataka figure	KATHPUTLI → legless Rajasthan doll
KUNDHEI → jointed Odisha figure	CONTROL → strings, but different bodies	KUNDHEI → jointed Odisha figure

CORE CLAIM
- KATHPUTLI → legless Rajasthan doll
- KUNDHEI → jointed Odisha figure

MECHANISM
- GOMBEYATTA → Yakshagana-styled Karnataka figure
- CONTROL → strings, but different bodies

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- KATHPUTLI → legless Rajasthan doll
- KUNDHEI → jointed Odisha figure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GOMBEYATTA → Yakshagana-styled Karnataka figure; CONTROL → strings, but different bodies.

09

STAGE 09 SHADOW, ROD AND GLOVE MAP

SHADOW, ROD AND GLOVE MAP · THOLU BOMMALATA · ANDHRA SHADOW · RAVANA CHHAYA · ODISHA SHADOW · PUTUL NACH · KERALA GLOVE · CLOSE DISTINCTION

THOLU BOMMALATA → Andhra shadow

RAVANA CHHAYA → Odisha shadow → PUTUL NACH / YAMPURI → rod → PAVAKOOTHU → Kerala glove

CORE CLAIM
- THOLU BOMMALATA → Andhra shadow
- RAVANA CHHAYA → Odisha shadow

MECHANISM
- PUTUL NACH / YAMPURI → rod
- PAVAKOOTHU → Kerala glove

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Lokadharmi is realistic and natyadharmi stylised
- the Sutradhar's classical stage role and puppetry's string-holder-narrator resonance are related but not identical, and puppet forms must

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Lokadharmi is realistic and natyadharmi stylised; the Sutradhar's classical stage role and puppetry's string-holder-narrator resonance are related but not identical, and puppet forms must retain material and region.

10

STAGE 10 PERFORMANCE VULNERABILITY TEST

PERFORMANCE VULNERABILITY TEST · TEXT SURVIVES? · ARCHIVE AND TEACHING · PERFORMER SURVIVES? · SKILL TRANSMISSION · AUDIENCE + FUNDING? · LIVING ECOLOGY · FORM-SPECIFIC SAFEGUARDING

TEXT SURVIVES? → archive and teaching

PERFORMER SURVIVES? → skill transmission → AUDIENCE + FUNDING? → living ecology → RESPONSE → form-specific safeguarding

CORE CLAIM
- TEXT SURVIVES? → archive and teaching
- PERFORMER SURVIVES? → skill transmission

MECHANISM
- AUDIENCE + FUNDING? → living ecology
- RESPONSE → form-specific safeguarding

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Prescriptive dramaturgical conventions are not a census of every performance
- Sitabenga-Jogimara priority claims, mask generalisations and falsely exact decline stories require qualification.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Sitabenga-Jogimara priority claims, mask generalisations and falsely exact decline stories require qualification.

11

STAGE 11 PERFORMANCE ANSWER SPINE

PERFORMANCE ANSWER SPINE · MODE, GENRE OR CONTROL MECHANISM · PATRONAGE AND PUBLIC · REGION, BODY AND INSTITUTION · CONVENTION, CONTINUITY AND VULNERABILITY

DEFINE → mode, genre or control mechanism → TRACE → patronage and public → COMPARE → region, body and institution → QUALIFY → convention, continuity and vulnerability

CORE CLAIM
- DEFINE → mode, genre or control mechanism
- TRACE → patronage and public

MECHANISM
- COMPARE → region, body and institution
- QUALIFY → convention, continuity and vulnerability

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DEFINE → mode, genre or control mechanism
- TRACE → patronage and public

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMPARE → region, body and institution; QUALIFY → convention, continuity and vulnerability.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · KUTIYATTAM (SANSKRIT THEATRE, KERALA) REMAINS UNESCO ICH-INSCRIBED · TREATING SANSKRIT THEATRE'S DECLINE AND PUPPETRY'S DECLINE AS THE · SAYING HISTORICAL SANSKRIT THEATRE NEEDS ONLY TEXTUAL STUDY · PRESENTING PUPPETRY AS MERELY A CHILDREN'S ENTERTAINMENT FORM · ASSUMING ALL FOUR PUPPETRY CATEGORIES FACE IDENTICAL DECLINE · INDIAN SOCIETY OWNS THE LIVELIHOOD AND SOCIO-ECONOMIC · GOVERNANCE OWNS CULTURAL-POLICY FUNDING MECHANISMS AS A PUBLIC

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- Kutiyattam (Sanskrit theatre, Kerala) remains UNESCO ICH-inscribed
- NOT: Treating Sanskrit theatre's decline and puppetry's decline as the
- NOT: Saying historical Sanskrit theatre needs only textual study.
- NOT: Presenting puppetry as merely a children's entertainment form. - The

ADVANCED DEBATE
- NOT: Assuming all four puppetry categories face identical decline
- NOT: Indian Society owns the livelihood and socio-economic
- NOT: Governance owns cultural-policy funding mechanisms as a public
- This file's completed-vs-ongoing decline distinction is reusable

LEGACY / NUANCE
- 00 Master-Framework.md Section 5 — the current-claim verification
- CAUTION: Cross-links: Topic 12 (craft-ecology safeguarding parallels),
- Verified against Nitin — pdf , PDF pp. 500-503 and PDF pp. 540-548
- CAUTION: Open caution: this file's account of the "reasons for decline" of

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels